

Castling has safety conditions

Foundations

THE IDEA

Castling develops a rook and relocates the king in one move. The king and chosen rook must not have moved, the squares between them must be empty, and the king cannot castle out of, through, or into check.

WORKED EXAMPLE

For White to castle kingside, e1, f1, and g1 must satisfy the king-safety tests. The rook may be attacked without preventing castling. On the queenside, b1 must be empty, but an attack on b1 alone does not forbid castling.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Can White castle through an attacked f1 square if g1 is safe?

ANSWER AND REASONING

No. The king's transit square matters. Castling is not a way to pass through check, even when the final square looks sheltered.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Prepare castling by clearing pieces and checking the king's entire route.